

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 7 6

♥ A 4 2

♦ 6 3

♣ K Q 10 9

♠ A K

♥ J 6 5

♦ A K J 4

♣ J 8 6 5



♠ 3 2

♥ 9 7

♦ Q 10 9 8 2

♣ A 7 4 2

♠ Q 9 8 5 4

♥ K Q 10 8 3

♦ 7 5

♣ 3

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

You obey partner and bid 2♥ but he then bids 2♠.

Partner has told you that he has an inviting, 9-point hand with 5 of each Major. He wants you to choose a Major and also decide whether to play game or partscore.

Despite your ♠s being so beautiful there are only two of them so you pick ♥s. And since you have a maximum 17 points you bid the game, 4♥.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 8 7 3
 ♥ K 10 9 6 5
 ♦ 7 5
 ♣ 9

♠ 9 2
 ♥ J 8 3
 ♦ A 10 6
 ♣ 10 8 4 3 2



♠ Q 10 5
 ♥ A Q 4
 ♦ K J 4
 ♣ K J 6 5

♠ J 6 4
 ♥ 7 2
 ♦ Q 9 8 3 2
 ♣ A Q 7

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			
4♠ by East			

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♥.

You say 2♠. Partner then bids 3♥.

Partner has a game forcing hand and is 5-5 in the Majors. He has asked you to choose one of them to bid game in.

With 3 of each you might be inclined to choose your stronger one, ♥s, but in fact that doesn't really matter since partner is probably stronger in ♠s.

What does matter is those minor suits. If the opening lead is a ♣ or ♦, which is very likely, you want the lead to be coming into your hand, not partner's. And in general you would prefer to have the stronger hand remain concealed. So you bid 4♠ where you will be declarer, rather than 4♥ where partner would be declarer.